S4 Table. Evaluation of factors affecting individual summary diagnostic accuracy estimates of pleural fluid assays.

Factor	Pleural fluid adenosine deaminase			Pleural fluid unstimulated interferon-gamma		
	Group (number of studies)	**Sensitivity**	**Specificity**	**Group (number of studies)**	**Sensitivity**	**Specificity**
Overall	- Total (N=45)	0.88 (0.85-0.91)	0.91 (0.89-0.92)	- Total (N=45)	0.91 (0.89-0.94)	0.96 (0.94-0.97)
Year of publication	- Up to 2010 (N=22)	0.91 (0.87-0.94)	0.91 (0.87-0.94)	- Up to 2010 (N=22)	0.92 (0.88-0.95)	0.97 (0.95-0.98)
	- After 2010 (N=23)	0.85 (0.81-0.89)	0.91 (0.89-0.93)	- After 2010 (N=23)	0.90 (0.86-0.93)	0.95 (0.92-0.96)
Design of study	- Prospective (N=43)	0.87 (0.84-0.90)	0.91 (0.89-0.93)	- Prospective (N=43)	0.91 (0.88-0.93)	0.95 (0.94-0.97)
	- Not prospective (N=2)	Not estimable	Not estimable	- Not prospective (N=2)	Not estimable	Not estimable
Burden of TB in country of study	- Not high (N=21)	0.89 (0.83-0.93)	0.92 (0.89-0.94)	- Not high (N=21)	0.91 (0.86-0.94)	0.97 (0.93-0.98)
	- High (N=24)	0.87 (0.84-0.90)	0.90 (0.87-0.92)	- High (N=24)	0.92 (0.88-0.95)	0.95 (0.93-0.96)
Proportion of TB patients in study population	- >50% (N=12)	0.85 (0.80-0.89)	0.86 (0.81-0.90)	- >50% (N=12)	0.92 (0.84-0.96)	0.94 (0.88-0.97)
	- <=50% (N=33)	0.89 (0.86-0.92)	0.92 (0.90-0.93)	- <=50% (N=33)	0.91 (0.88-0.94)	0.96 (0.94-0.97)
Effusion characteristics	- Only exudates (N=22)	0.88 (0.84-0.91)	0.90 (0.86-0.92)	- Only exudates (N=22)	0.93 (0.90-0.95)	0.96 (0.93-0.97)
	- Transudates also (N=23)	0.88 (0.83-0.92)	0.91 (0.89-0.93)	- Transudates also (N=23)	0.89 (0.84-0.93)	0.96 (0.93-0.97)
Assay methodology	- Guisti technique (N=29)	0.88 (0.84-0.92)	0.91 (0.88-0.93)	- ELISA (N=40)	0.91 (0.88-0.93)	0.96 (0.94-0.97)
	- Other, or not stated (N=16)	0.88 (0.83-0.91)	0.90 (0.88-0.92)	- Other, or not stated (N=5)	0.94 (0.81-0.98)	0.95 (0.84-0.99)
Reference standard	- Definite (N=24)	0.89 (0.84-0.93)	0.92 (0.89-0.94)	- Definite (N=24)	0.92 (0.88-0.94)	0.96 (0.92-0.97)
	- Composite (N=21)	0.87 (0.84-0.90)	0.89 (0.86-0.92)	- Composite (N=21)	0.91 (0.86-0.94)	0.96 (0.94-0.97)
Blinding in study	- Yes (N=5)	0.89 (0.80-0.94)	0.88 (0.80-0.93)	- Yes (N=5)	0.92 (0.85-0.96)	0.96 (0.91-0.98)
	- No, or not stated (N=40)	0.88 (0.85-0.91)	0.91 (0.89-0.93)	- No, or not stated (N=40)	0.91 (0.88-0.94)	0.96 (0.94-0.97)

Figures in parentheses are 95% confidence intervals for the summary sensitivity and specificity estimates
ELISA Enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay, TB Tuberculosis